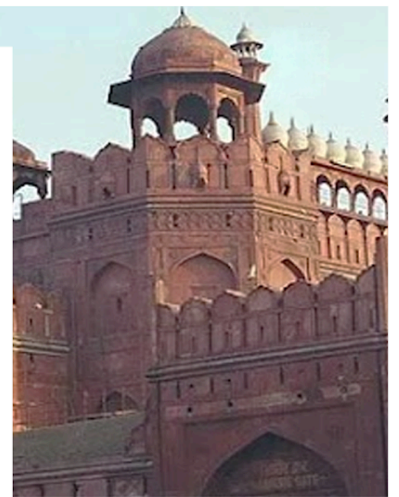
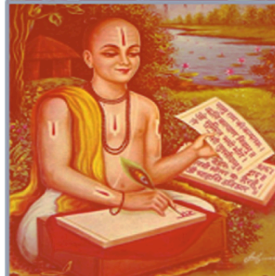
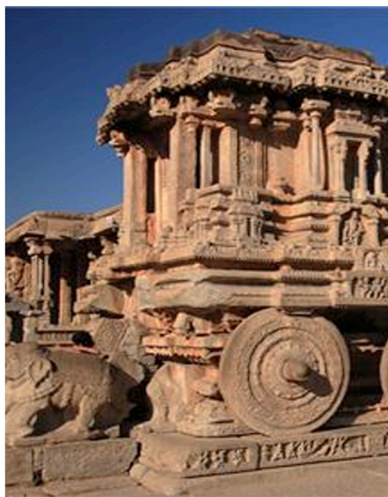


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Sufism



Sufism



The Sufi Movement in India

- Sufism refers to **mystical religious ideas in Islam**, which evolved into a movement by the **11th century**.
- Sufis stress the **importance of a spiritual journey under a Sufi pir** to establish **communion with the divine**.
- The foundation of Sufism lies in the relationship between **God, man, and love**.
- **Purity of the heart** is essential for Sufis.
- The **disciple (murid)** experiences different stages (**maqamat**) during their journey toward God.
- **Khanqah (hospice)** is the centre of Sufi activities, led by a **pir or murshid (teacher)**, where pirs and murids live together.
- By the **12th century**, Sufism was organized into **silsilahs (orders)**, representing the unbroken chain between a **pir and murid**.
- **Dargahs (shrines)** of Sufi saints became pilgrimage sites after their death.
- Important Sufi centres developed across **Iran, Khurasan, Transoxiana, Egypt, Syria, and Baghdad** during the **10th century**.

Features of the Sufi Movement in India

- The **Sufi movement began in India in the 11th century CE**.

- **Silsilahs (orders)** were led by prominent Sufi saints and named after them.
- **Union with God** was believed to require a **spiritual guru or pir**.
- **Khanqahs** were not just spiritual centres but also **learning hubs** distinct from madrasas.
- **Qawwali (musical congregations)** and **pilgrimages to dargahs** became common practices.
- Many Sufis were believed to perform **miracles**.
- Sufi orders had **varied attitudes toward politics** and rulers.

Sufi Orders in India

Order	Founder	Key Features
Chishti Silsilah	Khwaja Muinuddin Chishti	- Established in Ajmer by Khwaja Muinuddin after 1192 CE. - Emphasized love, tolerance, simplicity, and humility. - Associated with Qutub Minar and Sufi saints like Nizamuddin Auliya and Amir Khusrau. - Known for avoiding involvement in politics and distributing food to the poor.
Suhrawardi Silsilah	Shihabuddin Suhrawardi	- Introduced by Bahauddin Zakariya in Multan. - Maintained close ties with the state and accepted grants and posts. - Emphasized knowledge and mysticism. - Rejected Chishti practices like bowing before the pir and sama.
Naqshbandi Silsilah	Khwaja Bahauddin Naqshbandi	- Known for strict adherence to Islamic law. - Opposed sama and pilgrimage to shrines. - Advocated for a master-slave relationship with God. - Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi criticized Akbar's liberal policies and tried to harmonize mysticism with orthodox Islam.

Qadri Silsilah	Sheikh Abdul Qadir	- Promoted Wahdat al-Wajud (unity of existence). - Miyan Mir enrolled Mughal princess Jahanara and her brother Dara as disciples. - Dismissed orthodox elements and emphasized spiritual realization.
Firdausi Order	Shaikh Badruddin Samarqandi	- Branch of the Suhrawardi order, established in Raigir, Bihar. - Prominent Sufi: Shaikh Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri.
Rishi Order	Shaikh Nuruddin Wali	- Indigenous to Kashmir, influenced by the Shaivite Bhakti tradition. - Flourished in the 15th and 16th centuries in Kashmir.

Importance of the Sufi Movement in India

- The Sufis promoted **liberalism within Islam**, similar to the **Bhakti movement** in Hinduism.
- The concept of **Wahdat-ul-Wajud (Unity of Being)**, developed by **Ibn-i-Arabi**, gained popularity.
- Sufis exchanged ideas with **Indian yogis**; texts like **Amrita Kunda** were translated into **Arabic and Persian**.
- They served the **poor and downtrodden**, distributing gifts and food, as exemplified by **Nizamuddin Auliya**.
- Sufis emphasized that **serving mankind** was the highest form of devotion.
- They promoted **equality and brotherhood**, treating Hindus and Muslims alike.
- **Amir Khusrau** reflected this belief, saying, "Though the Hindu is not like me in religion, he believes in the same things that I do."
- **Sufis encouraged social reforms**, contributing to the growth of **regional literature**.
- Many Sufi saints wrote in **local languages** like **Punjabi, Hindawi, and Bengali**.

Contribution to Literature

- **Baba Farid** wrote in **Punjabi**, and his verses appear in the **Adi Granth**.
- **Shaikh Hamiduddin** translated Persian mystical poetry into **Hindawi**.
- **Syed Gesu Daraz** preferred **Deccani Hindi** for explaining mysticism.
- **Amir Khusrau** wrote in **Hindawi** and used Persian metres in Hindi poetry.
- Khusrau regarded the history and culture of **Hindustan** as his own and took pride in being **Indian**.
- He pioneered a new poetic style called **sabaq-i-hindi**.

Important Sufi Terms in India

Sufi Term	Meaning
Sufi, Pir, Murshid	Refers to a Sufi saint or spiritual guide .
Murid	Follower or disciple of a Sufi saint.
Khanqah	A hospice or residence where Sufis lived and taught.
Khalifa	A disciple entrusted with responsibilities within the order.
Zikr	Recitation of God's name as a spiritual practice.
Tauba	Repentance or turning towards God in remorse for sins.
Fanaa	Spiritual merging with the Almighty , self-annihilation in God.
Urs	The death anniversary of a Sufi saint is celebrated as a festive occasion.
Sama	Musical gatherings involving devotional songs or qawwalis.
Silsilah	Order or spiritual lineage within Sufism.
Dargah	Shrine or tomb of a Sufi saint visited for blessings.
Maqamat	Stages in the spiritual journey toward divine union.
Wahdat-ul-Wajud	Unity of Being is the concept that all existence is one with God.
Biddat	Innovation or practices not in line with orthodox Islam.
Hal	A mystical state of spiritual enlightenment.
Shariat	Islamic law is often followed by some Sufi orders.

Qawwali	A form of devotional music , typically sung at sama gatherings.
Ziyarat	Pilgrimage to the tombs of Sufi saints.
Shaikh-ul-Islam	A title given to a prominent Sufi leader within the community.